

OrchidApp

Recover OrchidApp on a Replacement Windows Computer

Step-by-step restore guide for a new, repaired or reinstalled Windows computer

Applies to: Windows 11 and a previous OrchidApp backup saved to a cloud-synced folder such as OneDrive, Google Drive or iCloud Drive.

User guide

Purpose

Use this guide when the old computer has failed, been replaced or been reinstalled, and you need to restore OrchidApp on a Windows computer.

The safest recovery route is:

1. install OrchidApp using the Windows installer
2. sign in to the cloud provider that holds the backup
3. wait for the backup file to sync to the computer
4. restore the latest OrchidApp backup ZIP using the OrchidApp Launcher

Start here

Follow the **01 - Install or Upgrade OrchidApp on Windows** guide first.

Install OrchidApp using the Windows installer before starting the restore steps in this guide.

Do not install OrchidApp by extracting a ZIP file or copying files over an older OrchidApp folder.

Before you start

- Install OrchidApp on the new or repaired computer using the normal Windows installer.
- Open OrchidApp once so the OrchidApp Launcher starts.
- Sign in to the cloud service that contains the OrchidApp backup folder.
- Wait until the backup file has synced to the new computer.
- Use the OrchidApp backup ZIP.
- Close the OrchidApp browser tab before restoring.
- Leave the OrchidApp Launcher window open.

Important: Restoring a backup replaces the current OrchidApp database and uploaded files on this computer. Continue only when you are sure you have selected the correct backup file.

Which backup file should I use?

Use the latest trusted OrchidApp backup ZIP.

The cloud copy is usually named:

```
OrchidAppDataBackup.zip
```

A dated local backup may have a name similar to:

```
OrchidAppBackup_YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS.zip
```

Only restore from a backup you trust.

Do not manually edit, unpack or rename the backup ZIP before restoring.

Quick checklist

1. Install OrchidApp on the new computer using the Windows installer.
2. Open OrchidApp once so the launcher starts.
3. Close the browser tab, but keep the launcher open.
4. Sign in to the cloud provider that contains your backup.
5. Wait for the backup ZIP to sync to the computer.
6. Optional but recommended: configure the cloud backup folder again.
7. Choose **Restore from backup** in the OrchidApp Launcher.
8. Select the OrchidApp backup ZIP from the cloud backup folder.
9. Confirm the restore warning.
10. Wait for Restore completed successfully.
11. Close and reopen OrchidApp.
12. Check that your plants, photos and setup information are present.

Step-by-step recovery

1. Install OrchidApp on the new computer

Begin with the **01 - Install or Upgrade OrchidApp on Windows** guide.

Use the Windows installer to install OrchidApp as per the guide.

3. Close the browser tab before restoring

Close the OrchidApp browser tab before restoring.

This helps make sure the database and uploaded files can be safely replaced.

Do not close the OrchidApp Launcher window.

4. Bring the OrchidApp Launcher to the front

Select the OrchidApp icon on the taskbar to bring the launcher window to the front.

The restore is started from the launcher, not from the browser page.



5. Optional: If you previously configured the cloud backup folder

If this is a new computer, it is sensible to configure the cloud backup folder again after the cloud provider has synced the backup folder locally. This will allow you to use this as your restore source.

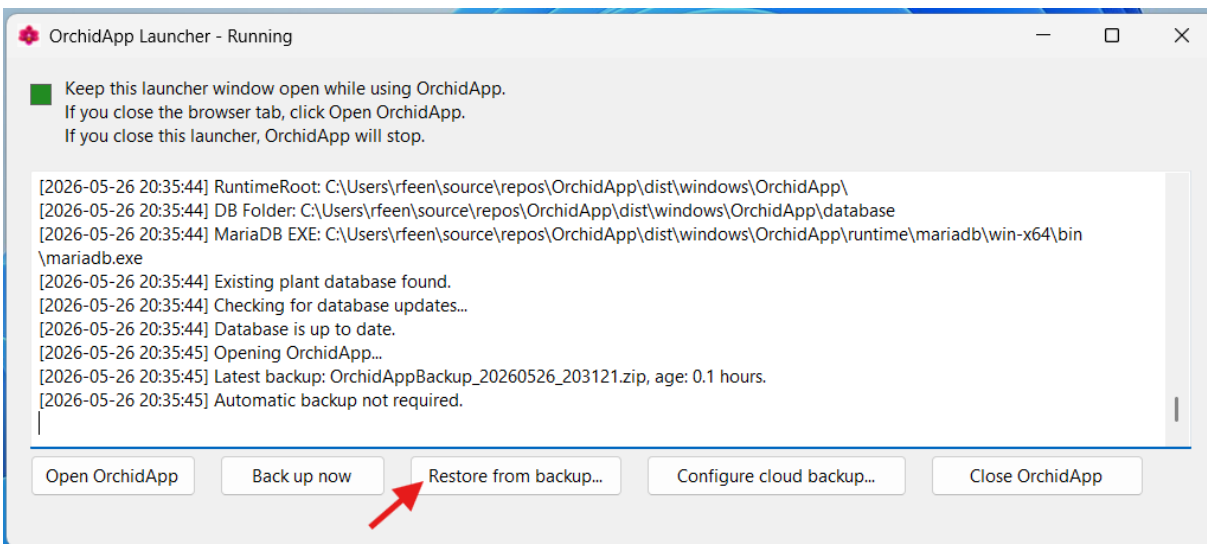
This does not perform the restore by itself.

Use the guide:

04 - Configure Cloud Backup Folder in OrchidApp

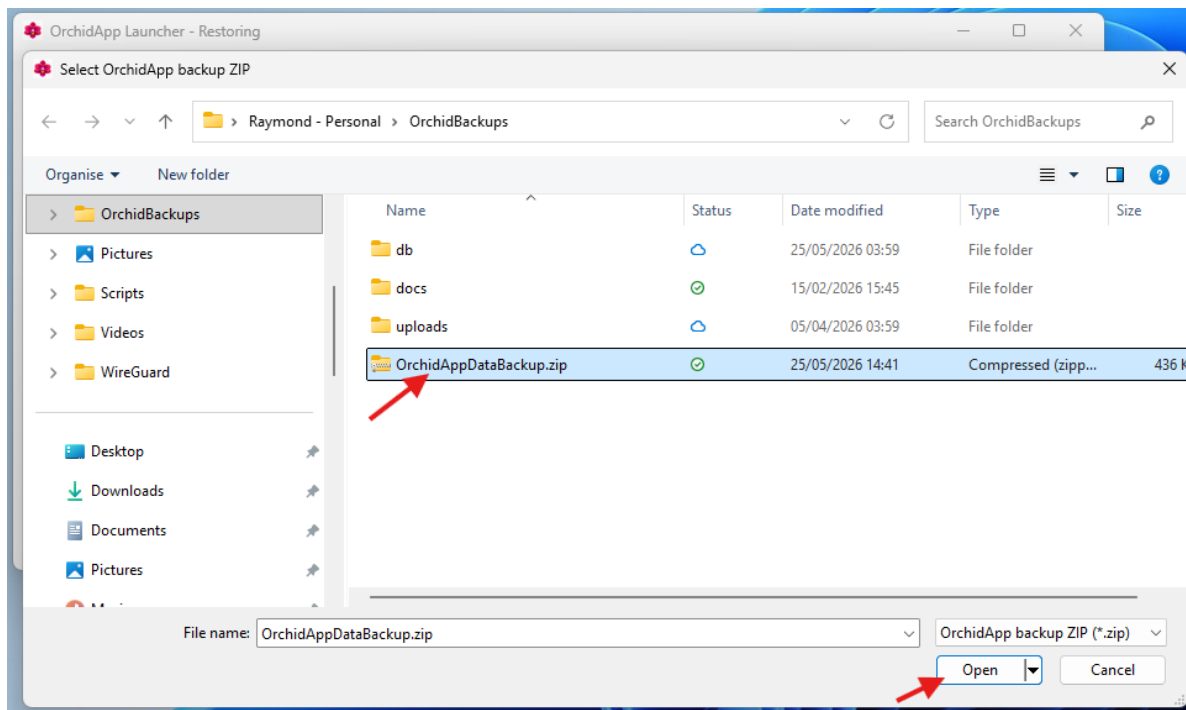
6. Start the restore

In the OrchidApp Launcher, choose **Restore from backup**.



You will now be presented with the files in your backup location. Select the backup to restore.

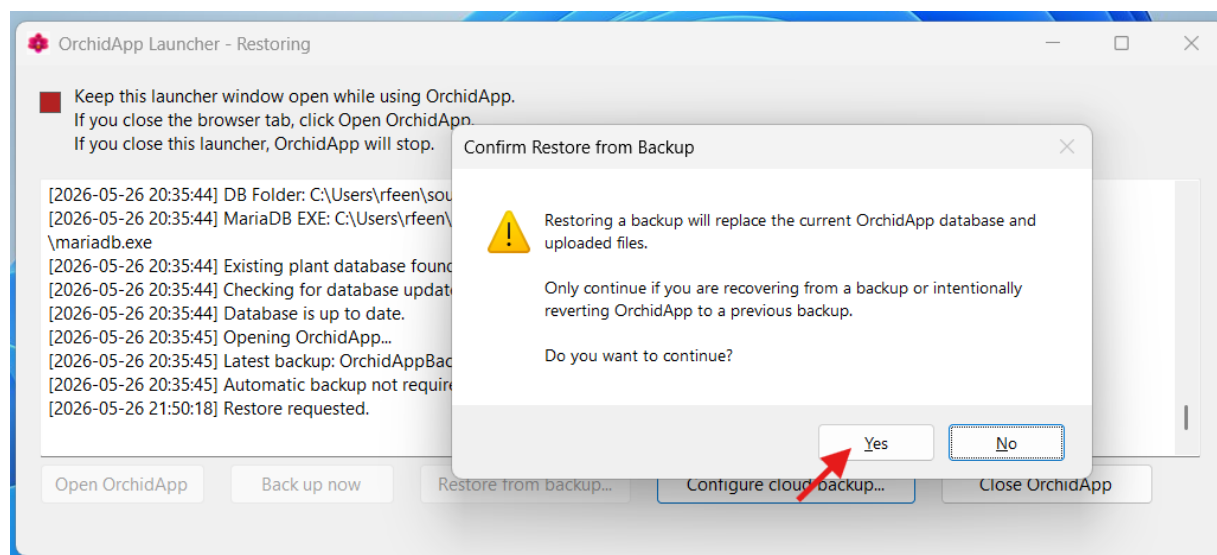
This starts the recovery process.



7. Confirm the restore warning

OrchidApp warns that restoring a backup will replace the current OrchidApp database and uploaded files.

Choose **Yes** only when you are sure you have selected the correct backup file.

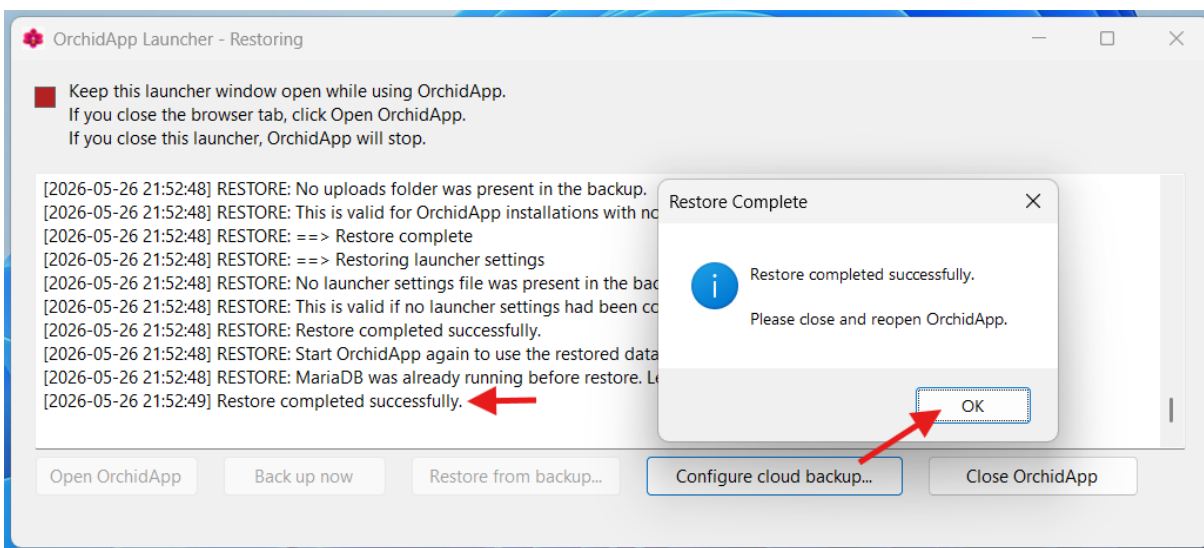


8. Wait for the restore to complete

Wait until OrchidApp reports that the restore completed successfully.

Do not close the launcher while the restore is running.

When the restore is complete, choose **OK**.



9. Close and reopen OrchidApp

Close OrchidApp fully.

Then open OrchidApp again from the Start Menu or Desktop shortcut.

This makes sure OrchidApp starts using the restored data.

10. Check your data

When OrchidApp opens, check that your information is present.

Check:

- plant records
- Plant Tags
- plant photos
- plant groups / genera
- species / hybrids
- growing locations
- growth media
- observations
- movements
- flowering records
- repotting records
- splitting, propagation and heritage

If anything looks wrong, do not add new data immediately.

Close OrchidApp and restore again from the correct backup file.

What the restore brings back

Restored item	What this means
Plant records	Plant names, Plant Tags, acquisition details and active or ended plant status.
Setup data	Plant groups, species / hybrids, locations and growth media.
Plant history	Observations, movements, flowering, repotting, splitting, propagation and heritage.
Uploaded files	Plant photos and other uploaded files, if they were present in the backup.
Settings included in the backup	Relevant launcher and backup settings included in the backup file.

Important safety notes

- Restoring replaces the OrchidApp data currently on the computer.
- Only restore from a backup you trust.
- Keep the OrchidApp backup ZIP in a folder that is synced by your cloud provider.
- After recovery, configure cloud backup again so future backups are copied to the cloud folder.
- Do not edit or unpack the backup ZIP manually.
- Do not copy database folders manually.
- Do not copy files into C:\Program Files\OrchidApp manually.

After recovery

After recovery is complete:

- keep using the Start Menu or Desktop shortcut to open OrchidApp

- keep the OrchidApp Launcher window open while using OrchidApp
- check that cloud backup is configured
- run **Back up now** after confirming the restored data is correct
- check that the cloud provider syncs the new backup copy

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
I cannot find the backup file	Check that you are signed in to the correct cloud account and that the cloud folder has finished syncing.
The Restore from backup button is unavailable	Close the OrchidApp browser tab and wait for the launcher to return to the normal running state.
The restore completed but photos are missing	Check that the backup selected was the complete OrchidApp backup ZIP and not a partial or manually edited file.
I selected the wrong backup	Restore again using the correct backup file. Do this before adding new information.
The app does not open after restore	Close OrchidApp fully, reopen it from the shortcut and check the launcher messages. If needed, restore again from the latest trusted backup.
My plants are not visible after restore	Do not add new data. Close OrchidApp and restore again using the latest trusted backup.
The backup file is in the cloud but not on this computer	Wait for the cloud provider to finish syncing, or download the backup file from the cloud provider's website.
I need support	Email OrchidApp@proton.me . Include what you were doing, what happened, and any launcher message.

Getting support

If recovery does not behave as expected, email:

OrchidApp@proton.me

When asking for help, include:

- what you were trying to do
- whether this is a new computer, repaired computer or Windows reinstall
- which cloud provider you are using
- the name of the backup ZIP file you selected
- what happened during the restore
- any message shown by the OrchidApp Launcher

The launcher support log is stored at:

```
C:\ProgramData\OrchidApp\logs\launcher.log
```

Recovery complete

Recovery is complete when OrchidApp opens and your plant records are visible.

Keep the cloud backup folder configured so the next backup is copied to the cloud automatically.